



"Preservation and Dissemination of the Mother Tongue, Based on Ancestral Knowledge and Practices, as a Form of Community Inclusion" in Tezapotla Tamazunchale, S.L.P. Author: Angelica Velazquez Hernández, Advisor: Luis Armando Mercado Campos

ABSTRACT:

The research project "Preservation and Dissemination of the Mother Tongue" seeks to strengthen community inclusion in Tezapotla, Tamazunchale, S.L.P., through the revaluation of the Nahuatl language and ancestral knowledge. Using a qualitative and participatory approach, the study documented traditions, cuisine, and storytelling. Interventions included recognition of indigenous women, meetings with community elders, a Southern Huasteca Nahuatl workshop for children, a reading club, and a culinary event. These actions demonstrate how the research was translated into practical strategies to preserve the community's cultural identity and legacy.

Keywords: ancestral knowledge, preservation, mother tongue, ancestral practices, community inclusion.

1. INTRODUCTION

The 2030 Agenda recognizes and promotes the preservation of ancestral culture and knowledge through several Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs). In accordance with the 2030 Agenda's SDGs and the results obtained from the assessment, the research question arises: How can we strengthen the preservation and dissemination of the mother tongue, based on the ancestral knowledge and practices of the community of Tezapotla Tamazunchale, S.L.P.? To answer this question, a participatory action research project was conducted with a qualitative approach, based on the socio-critical paradigm. The main objective is to generate strategies to strengthen community inclusion through the active preservation and dissemination of their mother tongue, revaluing ancestral knowledge and practices.

The research findings and interventions are intended to inform and enrich the ways in which ancestral language and knowledge are preserved and disseminated. The activities carried out—such as information gathering, interviews, document review, meetings with authorities, meetings with Indigenous educational centers, development of the strategic plan, and implementation of strategies—provide a solid foundation for addressing current challenges in the preservation of ancestral language and knowledge, with the participation of all involved, strengthening community inclusion through knowledge.

2. GENERAL OBJECTIVE

Generate strategies to strengthen community inclusion for indigenous peoples, specifically the community of Tezapotla Tamazunchale S.L.P., through the preservation and active dissemination of their native language and the appreciation of ancestral knowledge and practices.

3. METHODOLOGY

Tezapotla, a community located in Tamazunchale, San Luis Potosí, is a clear example of the cultural and linguistic richness of the region. With a population of approximately 2,531, it is distinguished by an overwhelming Indigenous predominance: 99.05% of its residents identify as Indigenous. Of this high percentage, 75.65% speak an Indigenous language. The community was chosen for its high percentage of Nahuatl-speaking population and its geographical location.

The research was conducted using a participatory approach to ensure active community collaboration at every stage.

Phase 1: Community Assessment and Relationship Building.

Phase 2: Documentation and Systematization of Language and Knowledge.

Phase 3: Creation and Management of the Dissemination Space.



4. INTERVENTIONS

Intervention strategies:

- **Generational Bridges: The Legacy of Women with Strong Roots.** Presentation given to girls from CBTIS 187 in Tamazunchale.
- **Recognition of Intercultural Indigenous Women:** More than 10 women were recognized.
- **Gastronomic Showcase:** More than 11 traditional dishes were presented, each with a review, and more than 200 spectators attended.
- **Community Wise Men and Women Meeting:** Open to the general public at the UICSLP facilities.
- **Mother tongue workshop for elementary school children:** more than 20 children attended during Science and Technology Week.
- **"Los Rituales" (The Rituals) Recovering Ancestral Knowledge:** An interactive museum opened during Science and Technology Week, attended by more than 40 elementary school children.
- **Nahuatl Reading Club:** With the collaboration of the University Center for Indigenous Languages of San Luis Potosí (CUALISAN)
- **Community Narrative Repository:** Recovering knowledge in midwifery, herbal medicine, rituals, customs, and community celebrations.



5. RESULTS

The research focused on the preservation and dissemination of the Nahuatl language and ancestral knowledge to strengthen community inclusion. Through participatory work with the community, the cultural richness of Tezapotla, which is predominantly Indigenous and Nahuatl-speaking, was actively documented.

The main findings of the diagnostic and documentation phases revealed that, despite the high percentage of speakers, the language and ancestral practices face the challenge of losing intergenerational continuity. The research confirmed that the mother tongue is the primary vehicle for the people's worldview, history, and values, and its preservation is essential to keeping their cultural identity alive.

The project strengthened social cohesion, ensuring that the cultural legacy is preserved and accessible for the future, ensuring the continuation of conservation efforts.



6. ANALYSIS

The project represents an effective model of participatory action research with a qualitative approach. Through this method, the community was not simply an object of study, but an active agent in the process, ensuring that the implemented strategies are culturally relevant and sustainable in the long term. It generates a social and inclusive impact, as it contributes to the SDGs, promoting equality and social inclusion while respecting cultural diversity.

7. CONCLUSION

Indigenous communities around the world face a significant challenge, one of which is the preservation of their native language and ancestral knowledge. This research went beyond data collection, but also focused on practical action. Documenting stories, ceremonies, and cuisine was not an end in itself, but rather the foundation for creating a space for cultural dissemination. Interventions such as the Recognition of Indigenous Women and the Nahuatl Reading Club demonstrate how the information gathered was transformed into concrete activities to strengthen community inclusion and ensure that ancestral knowledge remains alive and active for future generations.



8. TECHNOLOGICAL REFLECTIONS

Technology and ancestral knowledge are not opposites; they are complementary. By using digital tools, we can preserve and share cultural heritage, creating a powerful synergy that ensures the wisdom of indigenous peoples reaches future generations. This strategic alliance not only revitalizes traditions locally but also connects them to the world, allowing culture to transcend borders and empower communities.

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